

Patu
Close-quarters hand-to-hand combat was integral to Maori warfare and the warrior had several clubs for the purpose. The wooden *patu* was similiar in shape and deployment to the *mere*. According to Maori mythology, *patu* weapons were handed down by Tanemahuta, the God of the Forest and Tumatauenga, the God of War.

Tewhatewha
This staff weapon, 1.75m (5ft) or more in length, was used both for stabbing or striking. It is one of the best known and commonly taught weapons of the Maori. The elite warriors of old were skilled in the *tewhatewha* and *taiaha* (a similar long staff) because of the poise and dexterity needed to "get in close" to see the enemy eye to eye, which was the favoured proximity of the old school *toa* (warrior). Historically, the *tewhatewha* was used by the chief of a tribe to signal the time for an attack or a *haka* (war dance).

Mere
A *mere* (pronounced "merry")is a short club about 30cm (12in) in length. The rounded, sharpened top was used for thrusting, ususally at the temple, neck, or ribs, while the flat sides were used to deliver a blow to the falling enemy. Traditionally, individual *mere* were named. They were made from a heavy hardwood, or stone, such as jade.

Wahaika
The *wahaika* has an indent on one side that was used to catch and disarm a warrior's weapons. Most *wahaika* were made from wood or whalebone, but this example is made from jade, New Zealand's most precious stone.